

POS Next — Offline Mode Plan (Summary)

Goal: a cashier can run a **complete day offline** — open a shift, clock attendance, sell, record cash movements, create customers, and close the shift — with everything syncing safely once connectivity returns.

1 · Current State

Day step	Offline status	File / location
Open the app	Works	vite.config.js (PWA cache)
Re-attach to an already-open shift	Works	useShift.js (localStorage)
Open a new shift	Broken	shifts.create_opening_shift
Clock employee attendance	Broken	EmployeeAttendance.vue
Sell all day (invoices)	Works	invoice_queue + sync.js
Create a customer mid-sale	Broken	CreateCustomerDialog.vue
Record a cash movement / expense	Broken	DailyPaymentForm.vue
Branch balance / payment history	Partial	DailyPaymentManagement.vue
Close the shift / Z-report	Broken	ShiftClosingDialog.vue

Root cause: the proven offline pattern (invoice queue → sync → server-side dedup) was built for invoices only, and was never generalized to the other write operations — shifts, attendance, daily payments, customers.

2 · Architecture

Instead of building four separate queues, build **one generic operation queue** and **one sync engine** that reuse the proven invoice pattern, with **server-side idempotency** via a generic tracking doctype modeled on the one already used for invoices. Each feature only registers an operation *type* — no reinventing the wheel.

3 · Phases

Phase	What it delivers	Blocks the offline day?
0	Shared foundation. Generic operation queue + sync engine + server-side dedup doctype + auto-sync wiring + a unified "Pending Sync" panel with per-item retry.	Prerequisite
1	Shift lifecycle. Open a shift offline + close a shift offline with a locally-rendered Z-report (instead of the server printout).	Yes — starts & ends the day
2	Attendance + Daily Payment (the two you flagged). Cache employees & picker lists + queue attendance and cash movements + server-side dedup.	Yes
3	Offline customers + reliability. Create customers offline with temp-name remapping onto queued invoices + fix stranded offline payments + fix queue-loss & worker init-race bugs + dead-code cleanup.	Partly + prevents data loss

4 · Suggested order

Recommended: **0 → 1 → 2 → 3**. Phase 0 is small but everything else builds on it. To see Attendance and Daily Payment working fastest, do **0 → 2** first and defer the shift work — the two tracks are independent once Phase 0 exists.

5 · Recent updates on `develop` — plan adjustments

Uncommitted feature/permission work touches several files in this plan. **None of it adds offline support**, so every gap above still stands — but it shifts a few priorities:

Update	Effect on the offline plan
Create-customer button is now Administrator-only (<code>InvoiceCart.vue</code>)	Phase 3.1 refocused. The dedicated dialog drops to LOW priority. The real risk is the inline auto-create at checkout in <code>PaymentDialog.vue</code> — reachable by any cashier, already caches the customer offline but never syncs it . Fix that path (queue + name remapping onto queued invoices).
Attendance now carries a Shift Type (<code>get_shift_types</code> + <code>shift</code> field)	Phase 2: the offline attendance queue payload must include <code>shift</code> ; cache the shift-type list (already degrades to an empty dropdown offline).
Invoice history is now shift-scoped for cashiers (<code>get_shift_invoices</code> , dual <code>activeResource</code>)	Phase 2.4: neither resource has an offline fallback. Feed cached <code>invoice_history</code> into whichever resource is active for the current user.

Payment-method switching (removed "Clear All")	No offline impact — pure client-side logic.
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Decisions to confirm before coding:

- **Offline Z-report:** render the receipt locally at close time (recommended), or block closing until back online?
- **Standalone offline payments:** wire a real sync, or remove as dead code if the flow isn't supported?
- **Server-side idempotency:** one generic tracking doctype (recommended), or a bespoke guard per endpoint?